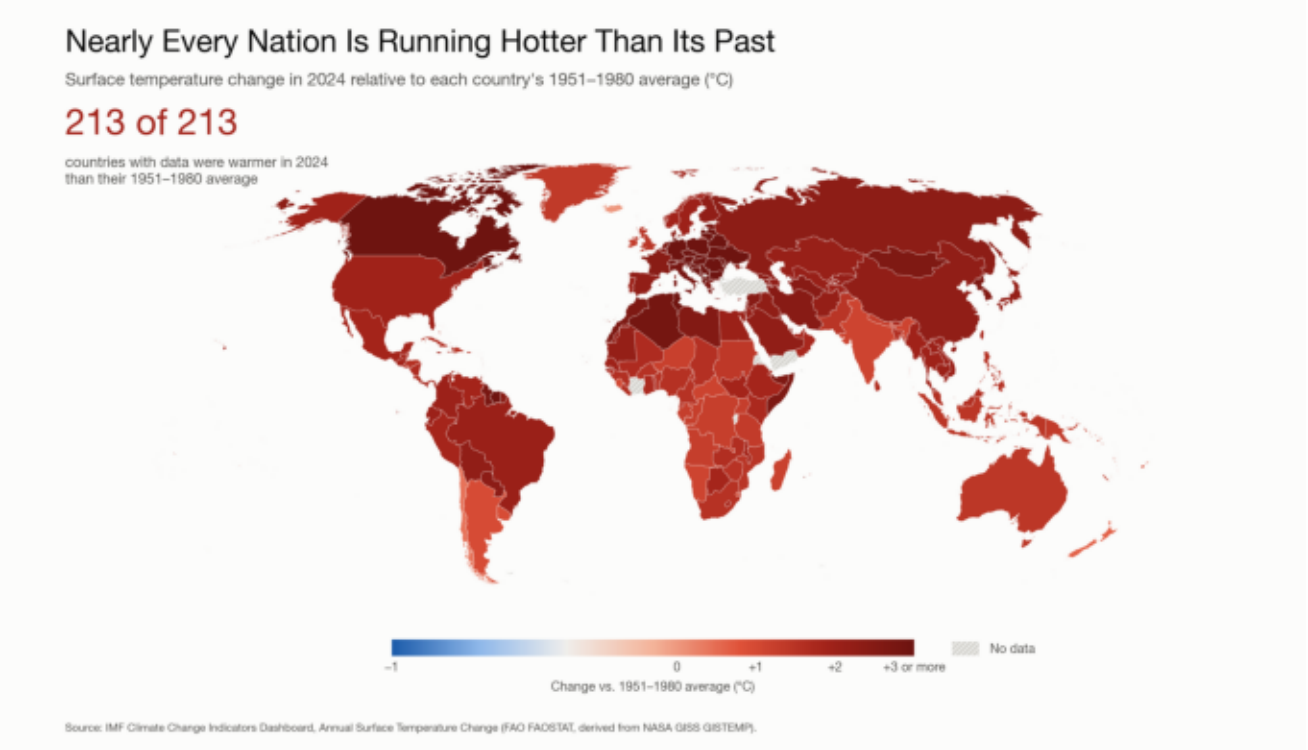
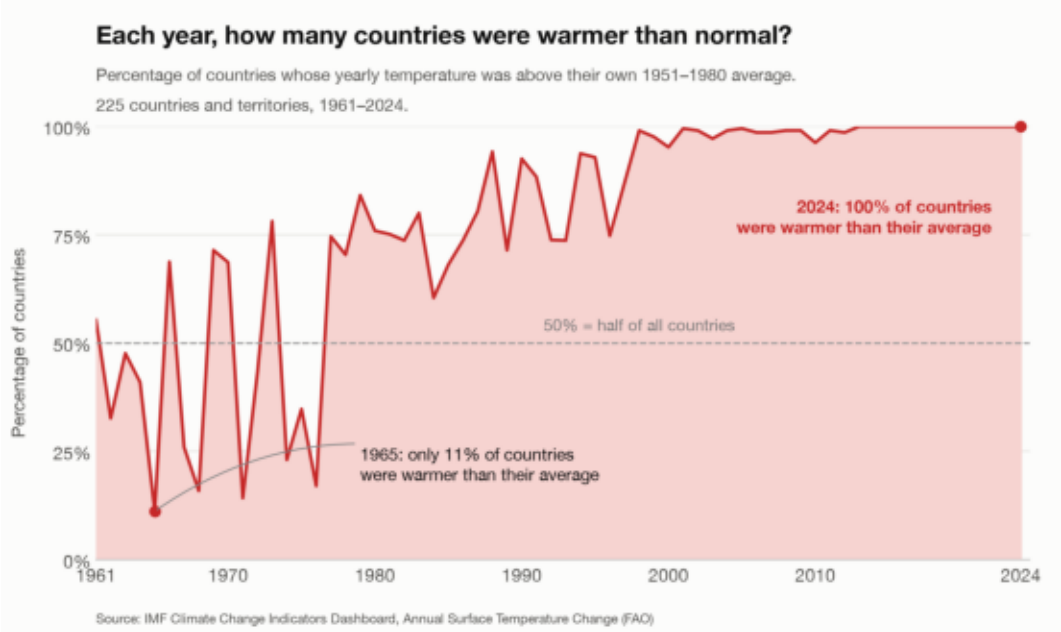
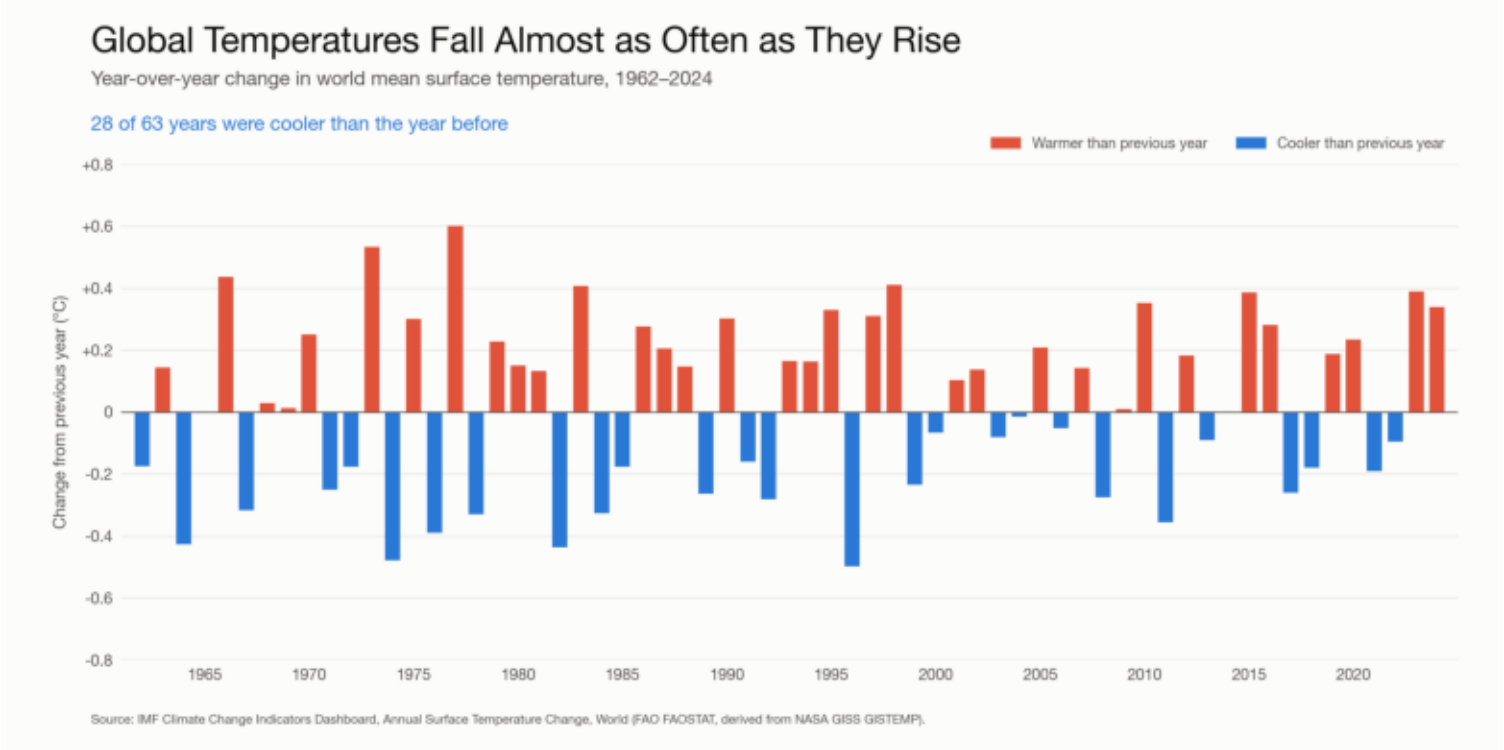
Side 1: Climate change is real





Side 2: Climate change is overstated



[Second "it's overstated" visualization goes here]

Proposition and deceptive techniques

Proposition: Climate change is real: global temperatures have risen meaningfully since the mid-20th century. (Group leaning: TBD.)

"It's real" side (Viz A, map):
- Diverging color midpoint shifted below zero (–0.3 °C), so near-zero values read as warm.
- Asymmetric, clipped color domain (–1 to +3 °C) saturates the warm end and leaves the cool arm unused.
- Area-weighted map form over-represents fast-warming high-latitude countries (Russia, Canada).
- Emotive headline with an exact, earnest callout and source to lend credibility.

"It's real" side (Viz A2, percentage of countries by year):
- Counts countries above their baseline instead of showing degrees, so a few very hot countries cannot drive the result, and small warming counts the same as large warming.
- A dashed 50% line stands in for "nothing is happening", so the early years read as random and the later years as a clear change.
- Red fill under the line, and only the 1965 low and the 2024 point are labelled.
- Axes, baseline and source are all accurate; the persuasion is in the metric and the framing.

"It's overstated" side (Viz B, bars):
- Shows only year-over-year differences, hiding the cumulative ~1.9 °C rise.
- Omits any trend or cumulative line.
- Cherry-picked frequency stat ("28 of 63 years were cooler") that ignores accumulation.
- Symmetric y-axis to make warming and cooling look balanced.
- Accurate labels and source citation so the chart reads as credible.